Producer Guide: Executing Release & Legal Documents

A practical operational walkthrough for Carte Blanche producers and researchers on executing contributor, minor, location, footage, and music agreements.

> ⚠️ **CRITICAL LEGAL DIRECTIVE: AUTOMATIC TWO-PARTY DISPATCH RULE**
> Under Carte Blanche broadcast compliance policy, release agreements are **only delivered to Legal (`release@carteblanche.co.za`) once both parties have signed** (the Contributor/Participant and the Producer).
> When a contributor completes an agreement remotely, the document is held securely in pending status and the Producer is automatically emailed a one-click review link. **Incomplete single-signature copies are never dispatched to legal prematurely.**

Signing Methods at a Glance

METHOD	BEST SUITED FOR	OPERATIONAL FLOW	LEGAL DELIVERY
1. Remote Online Sharing	Contributors off-site, pre-interviews, whistleblowers, or remote experts	Producer shares via WhatsApp, link, or email → Contributor signs on mobile → Producer reviews & countersigns	Automatic after Producer countersignature
2. In-Person Dual Signing	Field shoots where contributor and producer are physically present	Open form on tablet/phone → Toggle *"Producer Present"* → Both sign sequentially on single device	Instantaneous upon form submission
3. Offline Fillable PDF	Deep rural filming, maritime shoots, or areas with zero cellular signal	Download blank fillable PDF prior to shoot → Complete on iPad or print → Return when online	Manual email to `release@carteblanche.co.za`

The Carte Blanche Forms Hub

All production agreements and delivery documents are centralised on the Forms Hub:

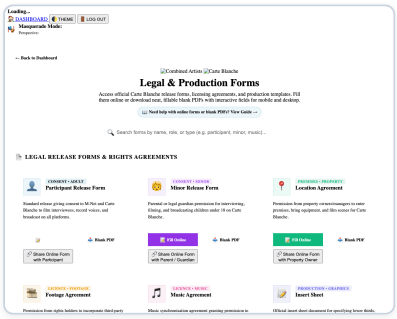


Figure 1: The centralised Carte Blanche Forms Hub showing action options for each production document.

Available Agreements: Participant Release • Minor Release (Parent/Guardian) • Location Agreement • Footage Release Agreement • Music Agreement • Post-Production Insert Sheet.

Method 1: Remote Online Signing (WhatsApp, Link, QR, Email)

Recommended when interviewing remote experts, whistleblowers, or participants prior to shoot day.

1 Open the Share Dialogue

On the Forms Hub, locate the desired agreement card (e.g. *Participant Release Agreement*) and click the green **"Share Online Form with Participant"** button.

2 Customise & Dispatch

Enter the **Story Title**, **Commissioning Number** (e.g. `2026-CB-042`), and Producer email. Choose WhatsApp, Copy Link, QR Code, or Email.

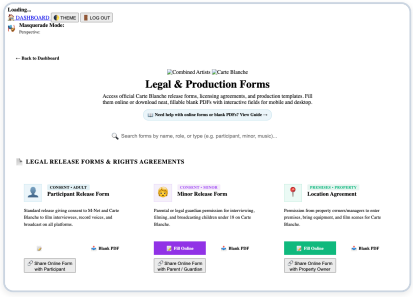


Figure 2: The Multi-Channel Share Dialogue with WhatsApp, Link, QR Code, and Email options.

3 Contributor Signs Remotely

The participant opens the link on their smartphone, fills in their details (name, ID/passport, phone, address), draws their digital signature, and submits. **The agreement is stored securely in pending status.**

4 Producer Reviews & Countersigns

You receive an automated email notification: `[Countersign Required] Participant Release – [Story Name]` . Click the secure link to open the Producer Review portal:

1. Verify the contributor's particulars and signature.
2. Sign your name in the Producer Countersignature box.
3. Click **"Approve & Submit to Legal"**.

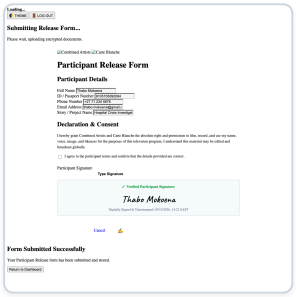


Figure 3: Producer Countersignature Review Portal displaying contributor verification and countersign panel.

Legal Delivery Trigger: Once the producer countersigns, the server compiles the finalised two-party PDF and dispatches it immediately to `release@carteblanche.co.za` and all signatories.

Method 2: In-Person Dual Signing (In the Field)

Recommended when filming on location and the contributor is directly with you. Both parties sign sequentially on a single shared tablet, iPad, or smartphone.

1 Launch the Form on Location

From the Forms Hub, click **"Fill Online"** on the required agreement card. Complete the Story Title, Comm #, Shoot Date, and filming venue.

2 Activate the "Producer Present" Toggle

Scroll to the signing section and turn on **"Producer Present? Sign Together Now"**. This activates dual signature capture on the same page.

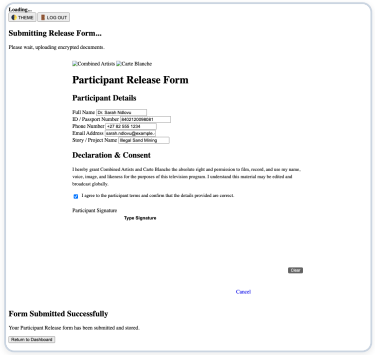


Figure 4: In-Person Dual Signing mode with Participant and Producer signature pads visible simultaneously.

3 Sign & Submit on the Spot

1. Hand the device to the contributor to enter their details and draw their signature.
2. Take back the device, verify your Producer Name and Role, and draw your countersignature.
3. Click **"Sign & Submit Agreement"**.

✓ **Both signatures are compiled immediately into an immutable PDF and sent straight to Legal (`release@carteblanche.co.za`). No follow-up review steps are required.**

Method 3: Offline Blank Fillable PDF

For remote filming in nature reserves, maritime vessels, or areas without network connectivity.

Download Pre-configured 2026 Fillable PDF

Before departing for location, click the grey **"Blank PDF"** button under the desired form. Save the PDF to your iPad, tablet, or laptop.

- **Digital Signing:** Open in Adobe Acrobat Reader or Apple Books. Fill in fields and sign using an Apple Pencil or stylus.
- **Physical Printout:** Print hard copies, sign with a pen in the field, and photograph or scan them upon return.
- **Submission:** Once back within cellular or Wi-Fi range, email the signed PDF to `release@carteblanche.co.za`.

Producer Decision Matrix

Remote Contributor

1. Click *"Share Online Form"*
2. Send link via WhatsApp or email
3. Contributor signs remotely
4. Producer receives review email
5. Producer countersigns online
6. → **Dispatched to Legal**

In the Field Together

1. Click *"Fill Online"*
2. Toggle *"Producer Present"*
3. Contributor signs on tablet
4. Producer signs on same tablet
5. Click Submit
6. → **Dispatched to Legal**

Offline / No Signal

1. Click *"Blank PDF"*
2. Download prior to shoot
3. Fill & sign on tablet or paper
4. Return to network coverage
5. Email PDF to Legal
6. → **Dispatched to Legal**

PRODUCER LEGAL CHECKLIST BEFORE BROADCAST CLEARANCE:

• **Minors (under 18):** Always use the Minor Release Agreement; parent/legal guardian consent is strictly mandatory under South African child protection laws and the BCCSA code.
• **Third-party Materials:** Use the Footage Release or Music Agreement for non-original video, archive, or soundtrack licences. Specify copyright owner, duration, and licensed territories.
• **Comm Numbers:** Always ensure the Commissioning Number is accurately entered for audit linking in the Carte Blanche archive.
• **Legal Queries:** For urgent broadcast advice or disputed terms, contact production management and the legal desk directly.